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AI-Driven Modernization Readiness Checklist

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What You Get from This Checklist

Readiness Score

See whether your system and team can start AI-assisted migration now or need groundwork first.

Map of Your Gaps

Unchecked boxes show exactly what's missing, from tests to code ownership rules

Next Step

Your score points to one move: a staged migration, a roadmap with an AI SDLC transition, or a full tech audit.

How to Use This Checklist

Check every statement that is true for your system and team today, then count checked boxes and find your score at the end. The score shows how ready you are for AI-assisted migration and what the Legacy Audit needs to cover first.

Legacy Modernization and AI Code Generation

According to Savanta, on average, an enterprise wastes more than $370M annually because it can't modernize its legacy systems. As technologies progress, the systems get outdated, tech issues and vulnerabilities accumulate, and the tech debt grows. Yet, many businesses refrain from modernizing their legacy systems. Lack of budget and time, along with the fear of downtime, are the primary reasons.

AI-assisted coding, which became extremely popular in 2025, seemed to provide a necessary solution for this issue. It offers the ability to cut both the cost and time of coding. However, in just a year, it became clear that vibe coding cannot satisfy all the needs of a legacy system modernization.

We at MobiDev have seen several of our clients trying to cut corners with AI and receiving subpar results at best. Why? The legacy system accumulates business logic that was meticulously planned and implemented over years, sometimes decades. Simply copy-pasting AI-generated code can break it.

In May 2026, Google issued its whitepaper, The New SDLC With Vibe Coding, by Addy Osmani, Shubham Saboo, and Sokratis Kartakis. It describes an ideal state of an AI-driven Software Development lifecycle, where AI participates in every stage, while developers supervise the output. This approach can be used for both building new products and modernizing legacy systems.

Surely, on paper and in theory, this AI-assisted modernization looks simple. However, when it comes to implementing it in practice, many companies find it hard to understand how and where to start.

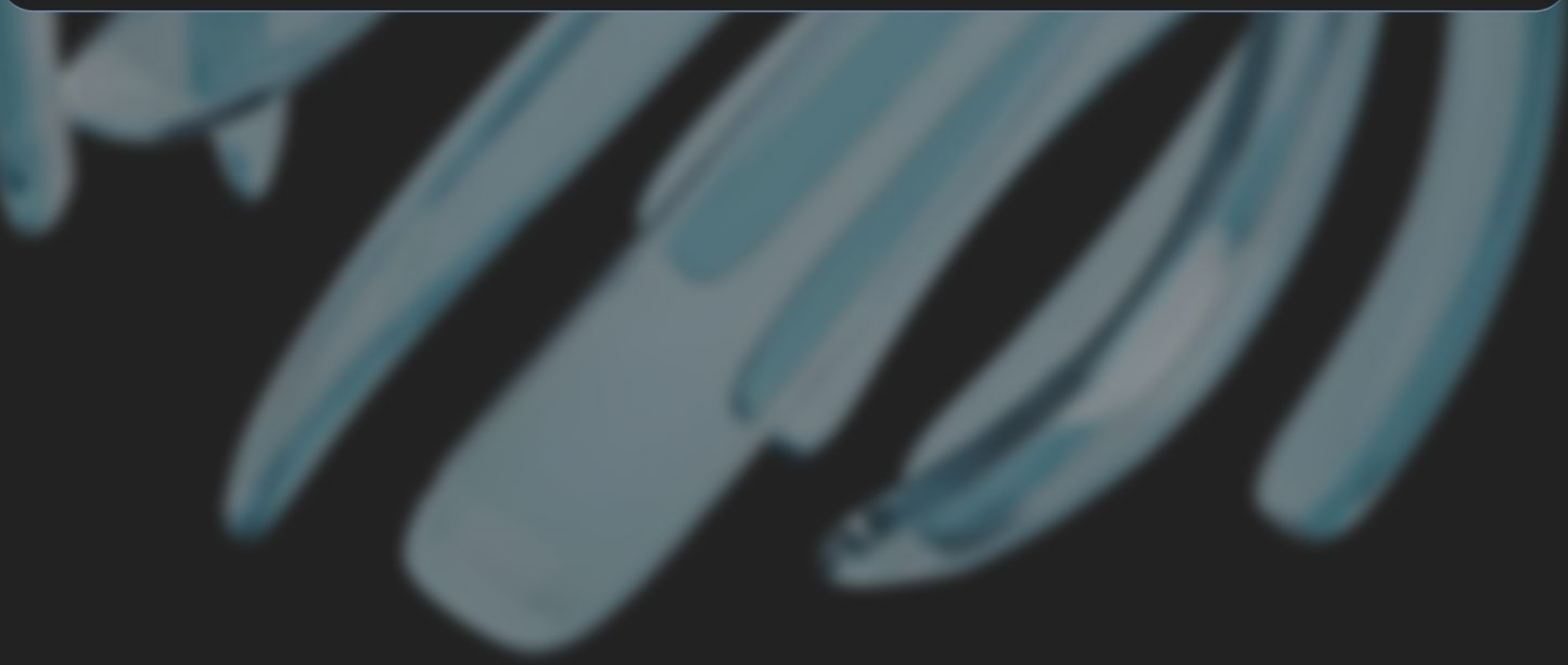
Having conducted 3 successful AI-driven modernization projects for our clients, MobiDev has summarized our experience to create this checklist. Its goal is to help businesses assess how ready their systems and teams are for modernization with AI SDLC.

Codebase and Stack

AI-driven modernization requires clear boundaries within which AI agents work with your legacy code. It's impossible if your development team doesn't have the necessary information about the system, including the tech stack, where the code lives and which modules are critical for revenue generation. With this knowledge, your team can plan the new architecture and give AI the necessary context for work.

Check Each Statement That is True:

- [ ] You have full access to all the source code and the control over repositories.
- [ ] The code builds and deploys from a repeatable script, not from one engineer's machine.
- [ ] Your team knows which modules/services hold the core business logic.
- [ ] You have documented high-level deploy and cloud architecture.
- [ ] You have a target stack in mind, or you're open to a recommendation.



Knowledge and Documentation

Software operates within clear business rules. The issue with legacy systems is that a number of such rules haven't been documented and exist exclusively as the team's implicit knowledge. When AI works with the code, it understands it "literally." As a result the implied business logic "gets lost in translation" and invisible errors occur.

Check Each Statement That is True:

- [ ] At least one person on your team understands how the core modules work.
- [ ] Business rules are written down somewhere: specs, tickets, a wiki or code comments.
- [ ] Your team knows where the undocumented logic sits, including the parts everyone is afraid to touch.
- [ ] Product, operations, or support staff can confirm how the system should behave.
- [ ] Engineers can get access to production logs or usage data to see how the system is used.

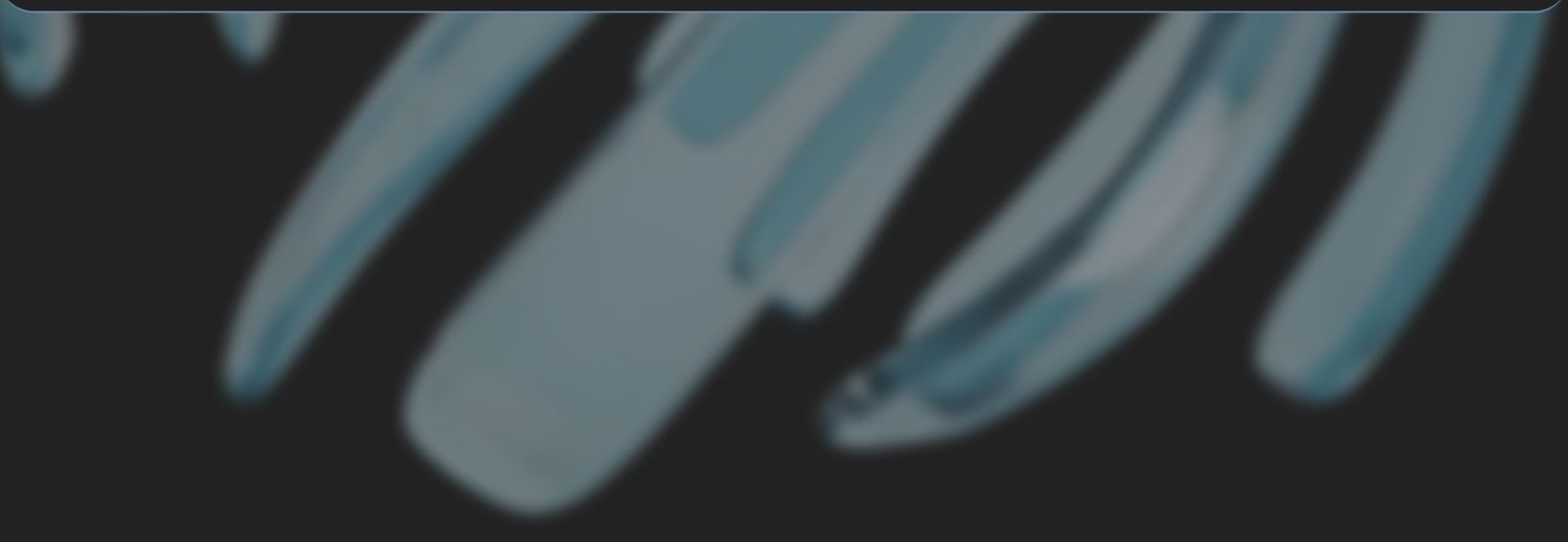
Testing Safety Net

Testing is necessary to check if the new modules work exactly like the old ones did. When it comes to AI-driven modernization, it's even more critical. Another aspect of testing AI-generated code is the bottleneck of human revision, as engineers cannot keep up with AI agents. The team needs testing automation to resolve this issue.

Check Each Statement That is True:

- [ ] Automated tests cover at least the core business flows.
- [ ] Tests run on every change in a CI pipeline.
- [ ] You have a staging environment that mirrors production.
- [ ] For each critical flow, your team can say what "behaves the same as before" means: inputs, outputs, reports.
- [ ] You have production-like test data that is safe to use, anonymized where needed.





Team and SDLC Readiness for AI

AI SDLC can only be successful if the development team has established review habits, shared AI rules, and architecture ownership. Without them, AI migration doesn't bring expected results, like cutting time, and in the worst-case scenario can even add new tech issues.

Check Each Statement That is True:

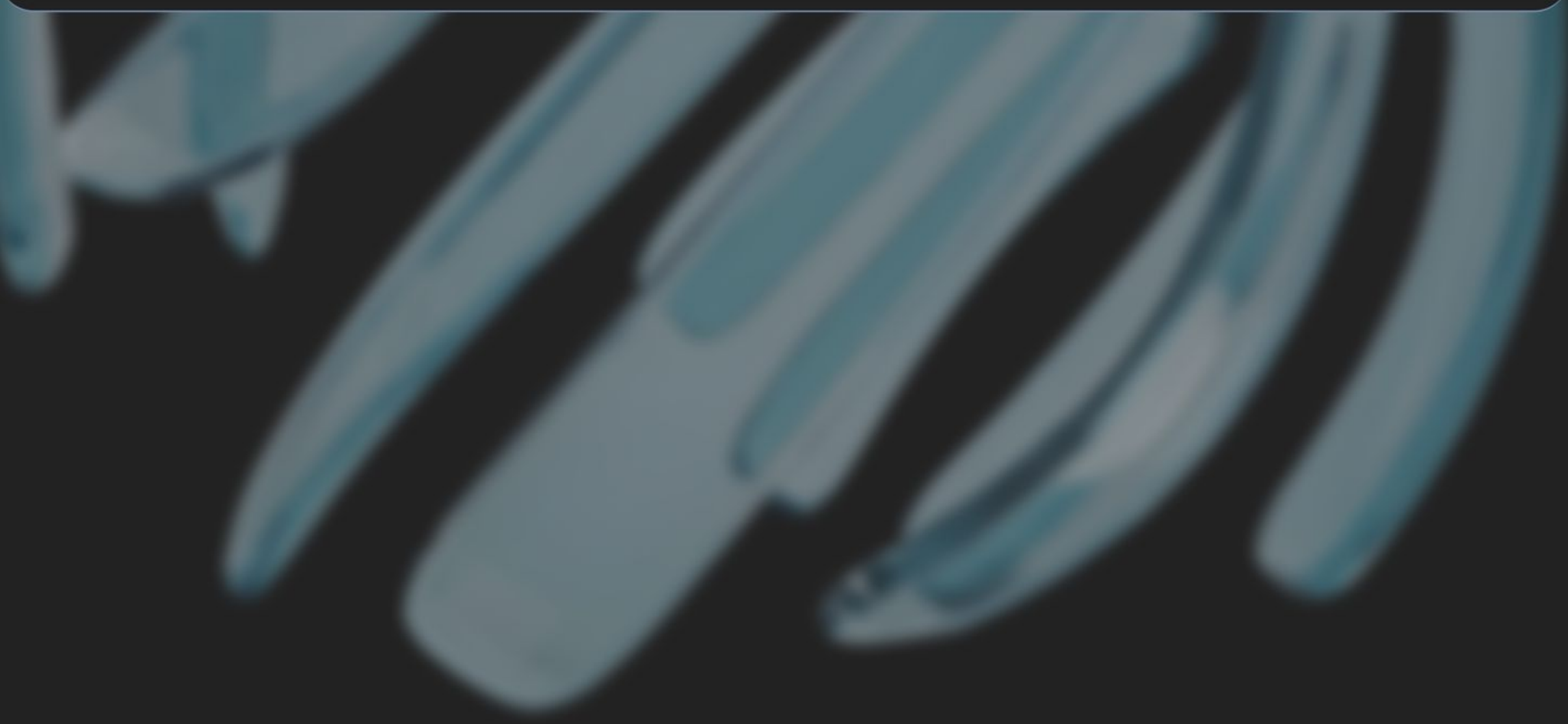
- [ ] Your engineers already use AI coding tools such as Cursor, Copilot or Claude Code.
- [ ] The team has shared rules for how AI is used, or agrees it needs them.
- [ ] Every change goes through code review before merge.
- [ ] A senior engineer or architect, in-house or from a partner, can own target architecture decisions.
- [ ] Your team has time to join architecture decisions and review AI output during the migration.
- [ ] Leadership accepts about 4 months of transition to AI SDLC before modernization runs at full capacity.
- [ ] Your team already has a shared project-related AI harness, skills, project docs or specs accessible to the AI agent.

Governance, Security and Code Ownership

Using AI to develop software creates a legal precedent, where code ownership is questionable. Before starting the full-fledged modernization, it's best to reach a clear understanding on several things: what data is fed to AI agents, who owns the output, and who approves it.

Check Each Statement That is True:

- [ ] Your company can grant a tech partner access to the repository and environments under NDA.
- [ ] Your team knows which compliance rules apply to the system (for example HIPAA, PCI DSS, GDPR).
- [ ] Your team knows which data and code must never be sent to external AI tools.
- [ ] Your company has a position on who owns AI-generated code and how licenses are checked.
- [ ] Accountable members of your team can approve every merge.



Delivery Constraints

Zero downtime is one of the key criteria of successful migration. However, it's only possible if your system consists of isolated modules that you can incrementally update with acceptance criteria and a rollback plan. Otherwise, you'll need to first break the system down into independent components.

Check Each Statement That is True:

- [ ] Your system is split into modules or features in terms of architecture.
- [ ] Your team can ship staged releases on a regular schedule while the legacy system stays live.
- [ ] You have a rollback plan if a release goes wrong.
- [ ] Your team knows which module to move first, or you're ready to decide during Discovery.
- [ ] Acceptance criteria for each module can be agreed before any code is converted.
- [ ] The budget is approved for a paid Legacy Audit before you commit to full modernization.
- [ ] Your system has feature flag infrastructure to handle dynamic runtime routing between legacy and migrated modules.

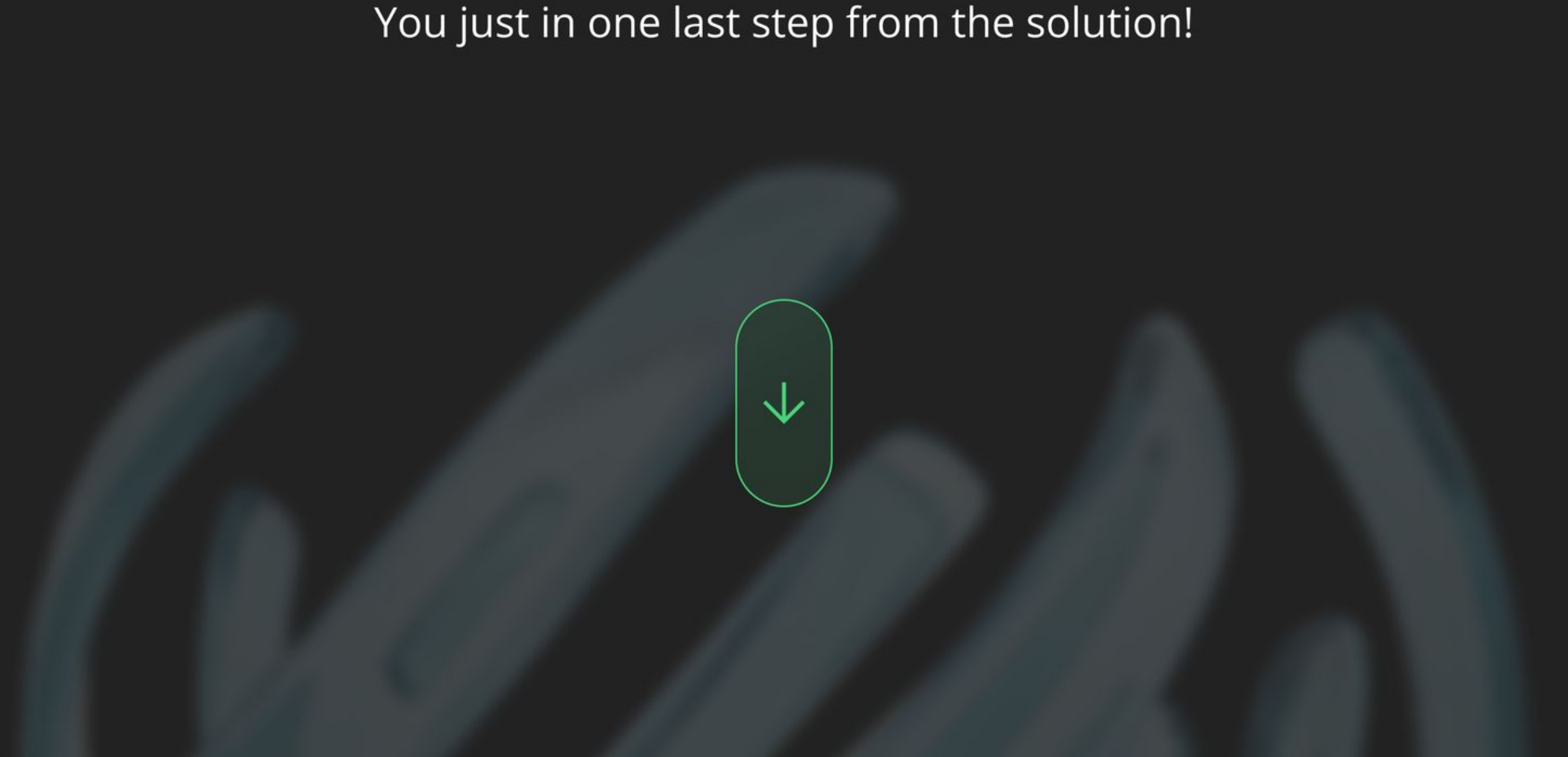
Your Score

Count the checked boxes across all six sections,
then read the results:

Score	What It Means	Next Step
25 to 34	You're ready for AI-assisted migration in staged releases	Legacy Audit, then staged migration
15 to 24	Gaps in tests, documentation or process will slow the first batches	Legacy Audit plus a Modernization Roadmap that covers the AI SDLC transition
Under 15	The AI SDLC transition and a testing safety net come before any code conversion	Tech Consulting: full audit and transition plan

What's Next?

You just in one last step from the solution!



Your Next Step in AI-driven Legacy Modernization

Claude Certified Architect



Yevhen Kuzminov

Solutions Architect
AI SDLC Expert

From my experience, moving to AI SDLC while modernizing a legacy product is challenging, especially when you're doing it for the first time. First, the same senior engineers have to lead both changes, so each week spent setting up the AI process is a week taken from the migration. Second, the legacy system can't stop either, and it still needs patches and support while the team rebuilds it.

Third, if your team has been using vibe coding before AI SDLC modernization, you might have additional tech issues within your system created by unsupervised code generation. Finally, the migration deadline might significantly limit your ability to experiment through trial and error.

That's why you need a tech partner that has already done it. We at MobiDev have completed 3 AI SDLC modernizations and bring that experience to every client project, so your team gets a tested process instead of an experiment.

Plan your AI-driven modernization with an architect who's led it before

Book a Call with Yevhen →

Why MobiDev

3 AI-Driven Modernization Projects in 2026	**91%** Middle and Senior Engineers on the Team	**Since 2018** Providing AI Consulting & Development Services	**5 Years** Average Client Retention
9.1 NPS As of the 2025 Client Survey	**4.9** Client reviews on Clutch	**77%** Of Clients are from North America and Europe	